

SME MARKETING IDENTITY

Business Brief Templates

RETAIL & FASHION Templates for Sub-Saharan African Businesses

Complete each template to generate AI-powered marketing strategies aligned to your funnel stages

01

Food & Agri-business

02

Retail & Fashion

03

Fintech & Finance

04

Health & Wellness

Personalised for Small & Medium Enterprises | Sub-Saharan Africa | Marketing Funnel Framework

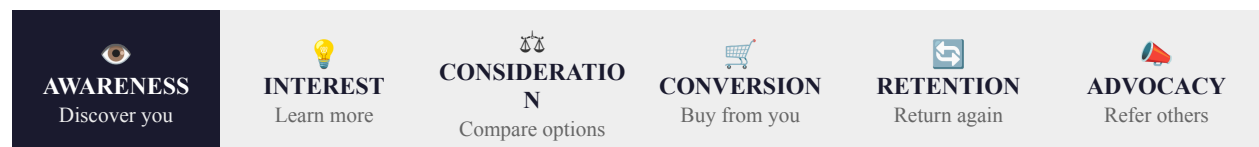
How to Use These Templates

These four templates are designed to help Sub-Saharan African SMEs build a comprehensive business identity brief. Once completed, each template generates a structured AI prompt that you can paste directly into Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, or any AI tool to receive a detailed, funnel-aligned marketing strategy tailored to your industry and context.

→ STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

- **CHOOSE YOUR TEMPLATE** — Select the template that most closely matches your business type (Food & Agribusiness, Retail & Fashion, Fintech & Finance, or Health & Wellness).
- **FILL IN THE FIELDS** — Complete every section honestly. The more specific your answers, the more targeted your AI-generated strategy will be.
- **USE THE AI PROMPT** — At the end of each template is a pre-built AI prompt structure. Copy it with your filled-in answers and paste into any AI assistant.
- **REVIEW YOUR STRATEGY** — The AI will return a full marketing strategy including funnel-stage tactics, a 30/60/90-day plan, content ideas, and KPIs.
- **IMPLEMENT & ITERATE** — Apply the recommended tactics, track results, and update your template every 3–6 months as your business grows.

◆ THE MARKETING FUNNEL STAGES



Retail & Fashion

For clothing shops, market traders, e-commerce sellers, tailors & fashion brands.

RETAIL & FASHION

For clothing shops, market traders, tailors, e-commerce sellers, fabric vendors & fashion brands in Sub-Saharan Africa.

Industry Context: Retail and fashion in Sub-Saharan Africa is characterised by a strong market culture, a growing youth consumer base, rapid rise of social commerce (selling via Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp), and increasing demand for locally designed fashion with African identity. Competition is intense, especially in urban markets, and visual content significantly drives discovery and purchase decisions.

Best suited for: Clothing boutiques, Ankara & fabric sellers, custom tailors, shoe shops, second-hand (bend-down) clothing dealers, online fashion stores, accessories & jewellery vendors, school uniform suppliers.



SECTION 1 — BUSINESS IDENTITY

Business Name

Enter your business name

Tagline / Slogan

Enter your slogan or leave blank

Year Founded

e.g. 2019

City / Town

e.g. Lagos, Nairobi, Accra

Country

e.g. Nigeria, Kenya, Ghana

Business Description

Describe what your retail & fashion business does in 2–4 sentences. Include how it works and who it serves.

Products / Services Offered

List your main offerings. Include price ranges where possible.

Unique Value Proposition (UVP)

What makes you different? Why should customers choose you over competitors?



SECTION 2 — MARKET & ENVIRONMENT

Geographic Reach

Select one:

☐ Local (1 city)

☐ Regional (multi-city)

☐ National

☐ Multi-Country

Key Competitors

Who else serves your retail & fashion market? What do they do well or poorly?

Market Opportunity

What gap or trend are you capitalising on?

Main Market Challenge

e.g. price sensitivity, low trust, infrastructure

Cultural / Regulatory Factors

Any cultural values, religious considerations, or laws that affect your marketing?



SECTION 3 — TARGET CUSTOMERS

Common customer profiles for retail & fashion businesses in Sub-Saharan Africa: Young professionals seeking stylish yet affordable office wear; students buying trendy pieces; mothers shopping for children's clothing; wedding and event shoppers seeking special outfits; growing middle class consumers seeking branded or premium local fashion.

Primary Customer Segment

Describe your ideal customer — who they are, what they do, their life situation.

Age Range

e.g. 25–45 years

Language / Dialect

e.g. English, Swahili, Twi, Pidgin

Income Level — Select one:

☐ Low income ☐ Lower middle ☐ Middle income ☐ Upper middle ☐ High income

Location Type — Select one:

☐ Urban ☐ Peri-urban ☐ Rural / Village ☐ Mixed

Customer Pain Points

What problems or frustrations does your customer have that your business solves?

Buying Triggers

What causes them to finally decide to buy?

Buying Barriers

What stops them from buying even when interested?



SECTION 4 — BUSINESS EXPERIENCE & MATURITY

Business Stage — Select one:

☐ Startup (0–1 yr)	☐ Early Stage (1–3 yrs)	☐ Growth Stage (3–7 yrs)	☐ Established (7+ yrs)
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Team Size

e.g. Solo, 2–5, 6–15, 50+

Monthly Marketing Budget

e.g. \$0, \$50–\$200, \$500+

Digital Presence — Select all that apply:

☐ No website	☐ Basic website	☐ E-commerce site	☐ Inactive social media	☐ Active social media	☐ Strong following
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Previous Marketing Efforts

What marketing have you tried? (WhatsApp broadcasts, flyers, radio, Facebook posts, etc.)

What Has Worked

Which efforts brought real customers or sales?

What Has NOT Worked

What didn't bring results?



SECTION 5 — MARKETING CHANNELS & TOOLS

Active / Available Channels — Select all that apply:

☐ WhatsApp	☐ Facebook	☐ Instagram	☐ TikTok	☐ X / Twitter	☐ SMS / USSD
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☐ Radio	☐ Word of Mouth	☐ Market / Physical	☐ Email	☐ Website	☐ Local Influencers
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Industry-relevant channels for retail & fashion: Instagram (product photos & reels), TikTok (try-on videos, fabric reveals), Facebook Marketplace, WhatsApp catalogue, physical shop display, local fashion events & pop-ups, influencer collaborations with local content creators.

Primary Acquisition Channel

Channel to Invest More In

How do most new customers find you now?

If you could grow one channel, which would it be?



SECTION 6 — GOALS & MARKETING FUNNEL

Primary Marketing Goal

What is the #1 thing you want marketing to achieve in the next 3–6 months?

Monthly Revenue Target

e.g. KES 300,000 or \$800 / month

Strategy Timeline

30 days / 3 months / 6 months / 12 months

Funnel Stages Needing Most Attention — Select all that apply:

☐ Awareness ☐ Interest ☐ Consideration ☐ Conversion ☐ Retention ☐ Advocacy

Typical funnel challenge for retail & fashion businesses: Retail businesses typically struggle most at Awareness (being discovered in a crowded market) and Consideration (convincing customers your quality and price justifies choosing you over the market stall next door). Strong visual content and social proof are critical.



SECTION 7 — BRAND VOICE & STORY

Communication Tone — Select up to 3:

☐ Professional ☐ Friendly ☐ Bold & Energetic ☐ Inspirational

☐ Humorous ☐ Cultural / Community ☐ Educational ☐ Spiritual / Values-Led

Brand Story / Origin

Why did you start this business? A compelling origin story helps the AI write emotionally resonant content.

Cultural & Community Context

Cultural values, local traditions, community ties, festivals, or language preferences important to your brand.

Customer Testimonials / Social Proof

Paste real customer feedback or reviews. The AI can use these to craft social proof content.

Brand Keywords

5–10 words you want associated with your brand (e.g. fresh, trusted, affordable, local, fast).

AI PROMPT INSTRUCTIONS

You are a senior marketing strategist specialising in Sub-Saharan African markets.

Using the completed business identity brief above (Template 02: Retail & Fashion), generate a detailed, actionable marketing strategy that includes:

A. STRATEGIC OVERVIEW — Summarise positioning and core challenge in 2–3 sentences.

B. MARKETING FUNNEL STRATEGY — For each relevant funnel stage (Awareness → Advocacy), provide 2–3 specific tactics, recommended channels, low-budget execution tips relevant to Sub-Saharan Africa, and an example content idea.

C. PRIORITY ACTION PLAN (30 / 60 / 90 Days) — A phased plan of top actions based on the business's current stage.

D. CONTENT STRATEGY — 5–7 content ideas tailored to tone, audience, and channels. Include WhatsApp-native and social-native formats.

E. BUDGET ALLOCATION GUIDE — How to allocate the available marketing budget.

F. METRICS TO TRACK — The 3–5 most important KPIs at this business stage.

Note: Emphasise visual content strategy and social commerce tactics. Account for catalogue features in WhatsApp Business. Suggest influencer marketing with micro-influencers (1K–50K followers) as a cost-effective option. Address the challenge of returns and payment trust for online orders.